Final Design Study

Coastal serenity for the creative at heart

Your quiet corner of the Oregon Coast

By Madeline Prewett

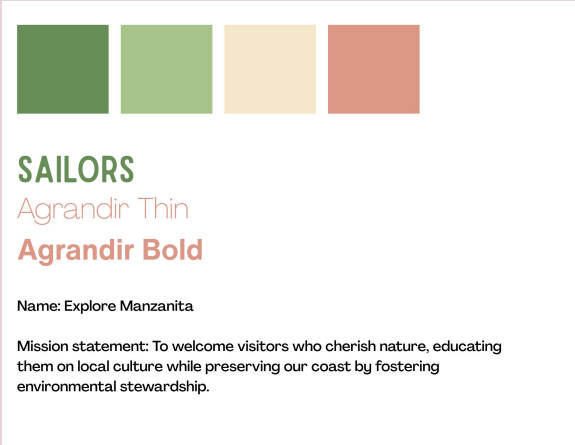
UX Research Method

- Collect feedback to redesign a brand identity and logo
- Understand users behaviors, needs, and preferences
- Three kinds of questions:
  - Visceral (first reaction), behavioral (what would you do), reflective
- Participants are anonymous
  - Record interview only to generate a transcript
- First interview: See each brand identity sheets once, and then reflect on both at the end of interview
- Second interview: See each logo once, and then reflect on both at the end of interview

The purpose of this research method was to remain neutral and make the experience as identical as possible for all the participants. The same script was used for every participant, and follow-up questions or reactions were limited, to ensure identical experiences and reduced bias for each interview.

Brand Identity

- Earthy colors to represent Manzanita as an “outdoorsy” destination
- Actionable mission statement
  - Both focused on it being quiet destination, first vs. second statement appeal to artsy or sustainability focused crowd
- Bold, simple fonts



Meet the participants

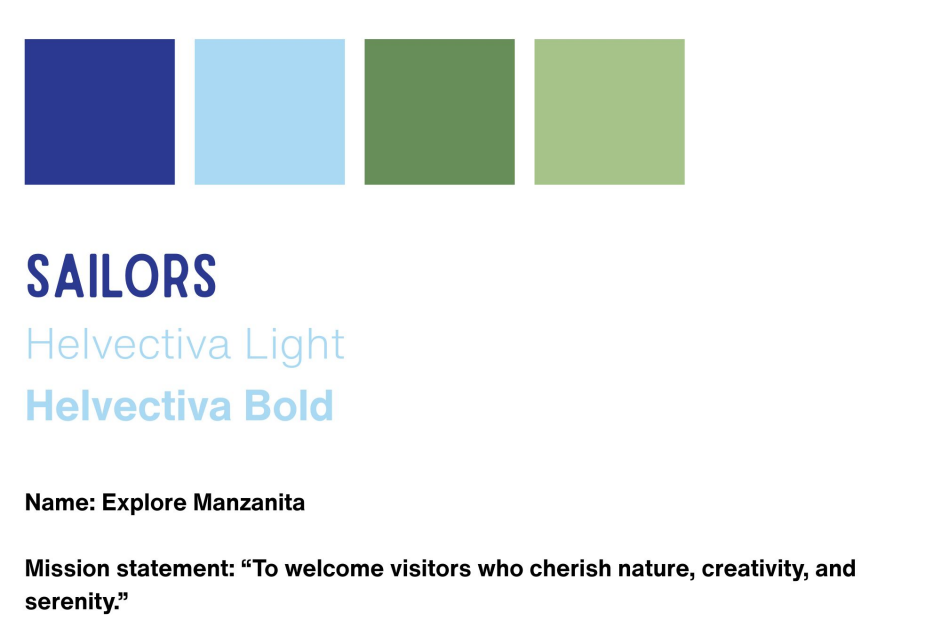
User #1:	User #2:	User #3:	User #3:
Age: 15-25 Gender: Female Occupations: Student Gave the most repetitive answers, seemed the least interested.	Age: 15-25 Gender: Female Occupation: Student Had very strong yes or no opinions, overall did not take the questions very seriously, shorter answers.	Age: 15-25 Gender: Female Occupation: Student, Tutor, Server Gave the most detailed feedback, related each logo to destinations and potential visitors.	Age: 15-25 Gender: Female Occupation: Student, Accounting Intern Their feedback was more driven by personal preference, had more emotional reaction with specific memories.

Participant insights

- Confusion by the absence of blue colors being used since it is a a coastal destination
  - Brown described as “ugly” by two users
  - Pink described as “random” by two users
- Unanimous agreement that “Explore Manzanita” was a better name
  - Self-explanatory for simple marketing
- Second mission statement had a clearer, more relevant message but was too long
- No strong opinions on body text
- Sailors font preferred for being less elegant

Final Brand Identity

- Brought in the blue
  - Vibrant hues
- Stayed away from strategic naming, kept it simple (“Explore Manzaita”) to bring attention to the town’s name
- Shortened mission statement



A/B Logo Designs

- Meaningful symbol
  - Pictorial, literal wave vs abstract wave/trail
- Coastal (blue) vs forest/adventurous (green) color scheme
- Two different tag lines, focused on creativity vs. intimacy/being a quiet destination

EXPLORE MANZANITA

Coastal serenity for the creative at heart

EXPLORE MANZANITA

Your quiet corner of the Oregon Coast

Participant insights

- Liked the clearer symbolism of a wave versus the line
- Confusion about the strictly green color scheme
- Logo A, eyes are drawn more to the symbol than the city's name
- 2/4 users strongly preferred Logo A, but might have been drawn to it for the wrong reasons
    - Associated logo with beach towns like LA
    - Less unique and adventurous
        - I want to market Manzanita as a more outdoorsy/woodsy destination than simply a beach town. If we are advertising to visitors outside the PNW, I don't want them to expect a typical "beach" vacation, the Oregon coast is more for hiking and exploring the small towns. So, even though the first logo (the blue one) was popular, I think participants were drawn to it for the wrong reasons.
- Agreement about the second tagline being more effective

Final logo design:

- Changed the wave icon to be more obvious
  - Also centered it more in the middle of the “E”, having the wave towards the bottom of the “E” was seen as unsettling
- Combined the green and blue (changed the blue to a more muted tone to match the green)
- Decreased the thickness of “Manzanita” letter outline so there are not strange gaps

EXPLORE
MANZANITA
Your quiet corner of the Oregon Coast

(Boilerplate)
Thank you for agreeing to participate in my UX research project. We'll look at 2 logo designs, and I'll ask you questions that will help me gather data about the effectiveness of the logo based off of first glance. I am conducting this interview under the instruction of Professor Stephen Quigley in his Integrating Writing and Design course at the University of Pittsburgh. I will record this interview for the purposes of generating a transcript. I will delete your recording after the transcript is completed. Do you have any questions? Do you agree to these terms?

(No response) Thank you for your consideration. I hope you have a great day.
(Yes response) Great, let's get started. I'm going to start the recording. (Start recording.)

Please state your occupation and age range group between the ages of 15-25, 25-40, 40-50.
Now I will show you the first of two logos.
(Show first logo)
Visceral Questions
Where do your eyes land after looking at the design?
What was your first feeling when you saw this logo?
What is your immediate reaction to the colors in this logo?
How do you feel about the use of shapes within the logo?
Behavioral Questions
Does anything feel out of place or unnecessary?
Would you click on this logo if it was a thumbnail for a social media page or an advertisement?
What do the colors and fonts make you feel?
If you saw this logo in public, would you want to learn more about the brand? Why or why not?
The tag line is " ". Based on this tagline, what kind of people do you think would enjoy traveling to Manzanita?
Now I will show you the second logo and repeat these questions.
(Repeat all above questions for second logo, then show the slide with all three logos and proceed to reflective questions).
Now that you have seen both logos, I want you to compare them a bit.
Reflective Questions
Are any of these logos repetitive?
Which logo feels the most trustworthy?
Which logo feels the most professional?
Do you prefer simpler logo designs?
Which logo is your favorite?
Which color scheme is your favorite?
Does the purpose of these logos come across clearly to represent a coastal tourist destination in the PNW?

Thank you for your time, I will now conclude the recording.

Interview transcripts:
https://bit.ly/4u48aJ9

Interview scripts:
https://bit.ly/4mPOhDp